

Night-time low flying over Brockenhurst

Bournemouth Airport arrivals — evidence summary, 2023-2025

Heights are from aircraft's own broadcast (ADS-B) position data via the OPDI / OpenSky open dataset.

Bournemouth Airport is required to have arriving aircraft descend gently with engines near idle — a quiet 'continuous descent'. Over Brockenhurst (about 10 miles out, directly under the runway-26 approach) that puts a plane at roughly 3,100 ft. The airport's own published rule says aircraft must not be below 2,000 ft here. The data below shows night-time airliners routinely lower than both — flying low and level, which needs engine power, which is the noise residents hear. And it is getting worse every year.

28 → 80

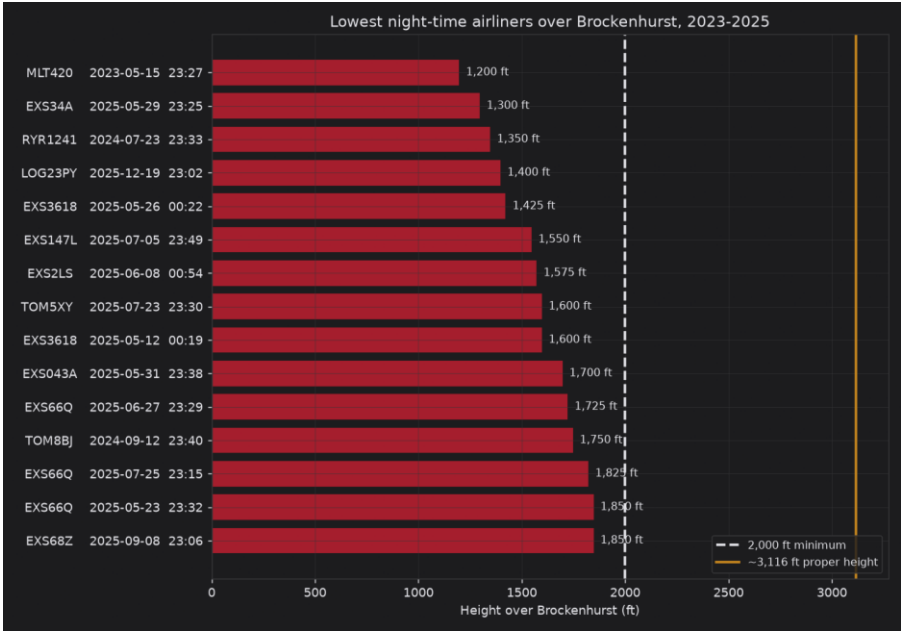
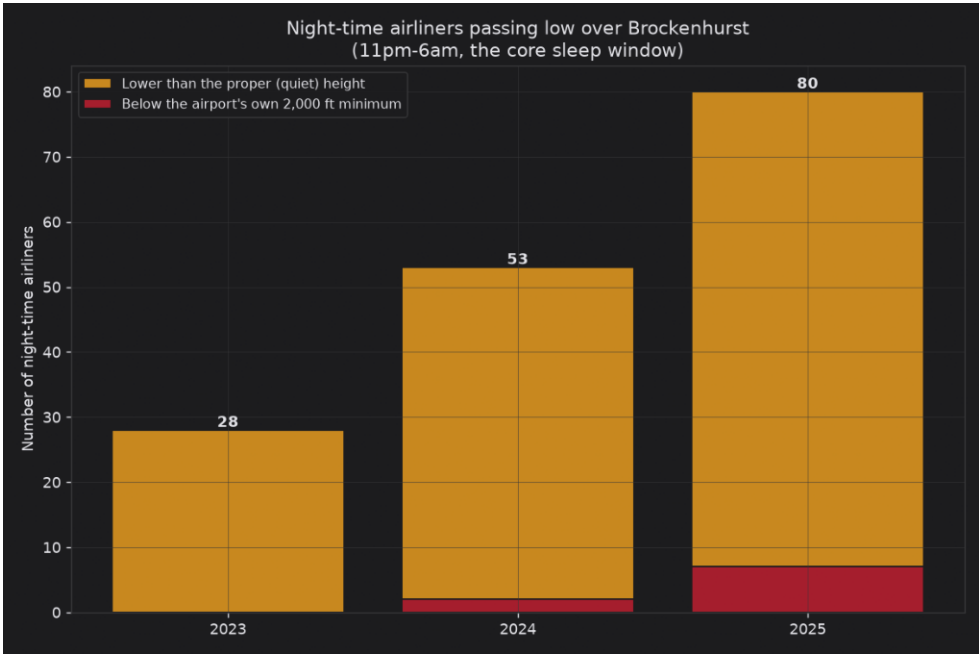
night airliners below the quiet-descent height per year (2023 → 2025)

0 → 7

per year below the airport's own 2,000 ft minimum

1,200 ft

lowest night airliner (MLT420, 2023-05-15)



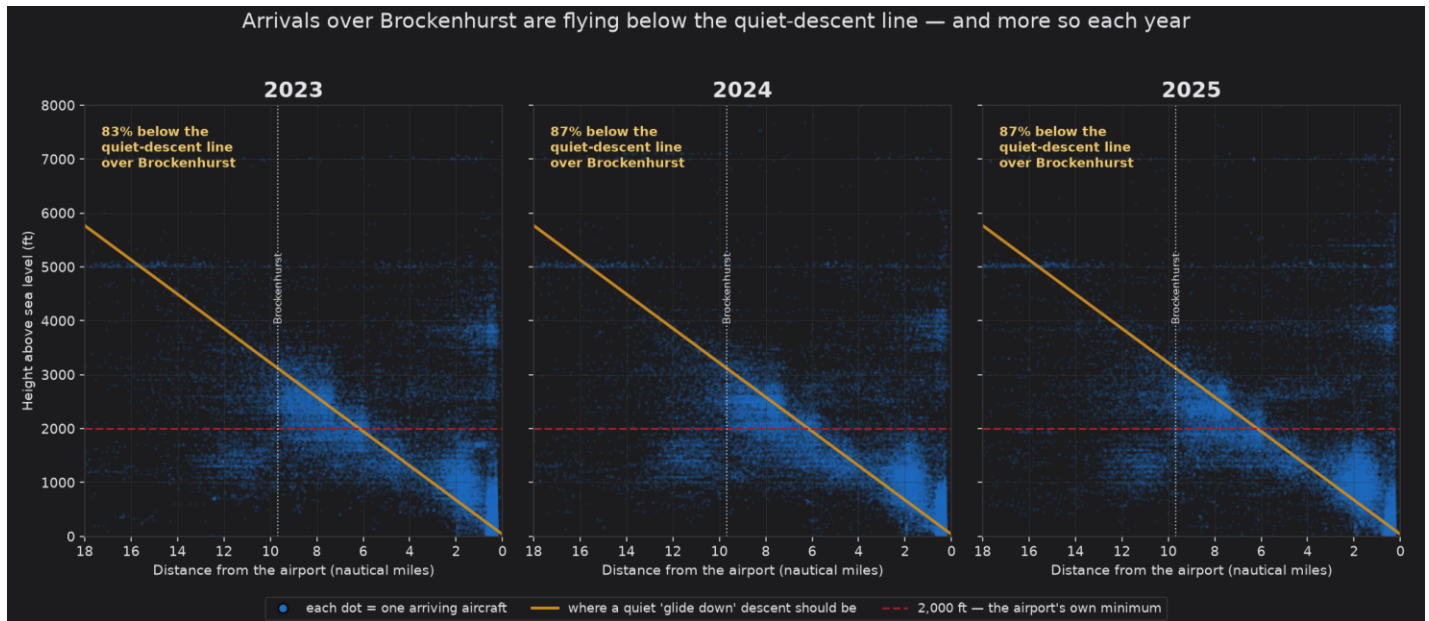
Over 2023-2025: 315 night airliners stopped descending (levelled off) directly over the village; 9 dropped below the airport's own 2,000 ft minimum. Every airline named in the residents' audit (Jet2, TUI, Ryanair) is confirmed low at night in this data. Method & limits: only aircraft broadcasting position at low level are captured (~half to two-thirds of arrivals), so these are minimum counts. A single flight may have an air-traffic reason; the evidence is the consistent, worsening pattern. Full method: METHODOLOGY.md. Prepared from public data — not affiliated with the airport.

Aircraft are flying below the quiet descent

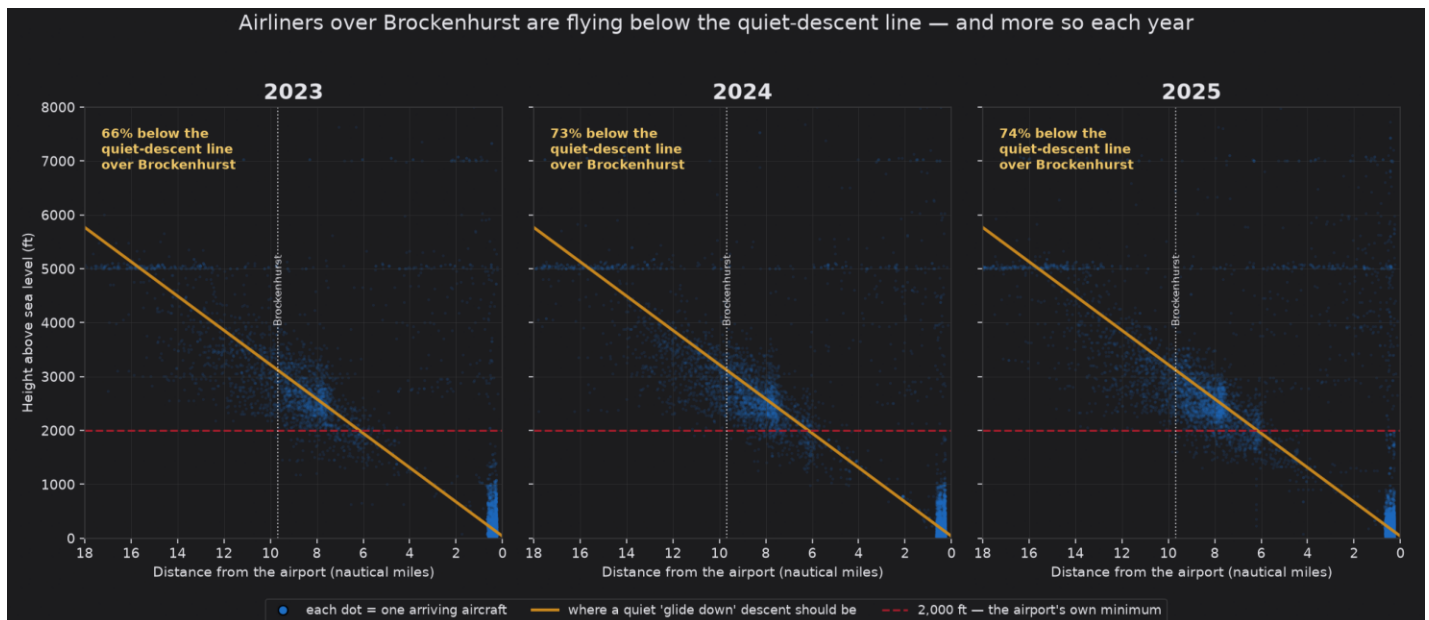
Height over Brockenhurst vs. where a quiet descent should be, 2023-2025

Each blue dot is one arriving aircraft, plotted by how high it is (up the side) and how far from the airport it is (along the bottom — Brockenhurst is the dotted line, about 10 miles out). The orange line is where a quiet 'glide down' descent should be; the red dashed line is the airport's own 2,000 ft minimum. The mass of aircraft sits **BELOW** the orange line — lower than a quiet descent — and the share below it grows every year.

All arrivals



Large passenger jets only (the airliners the case is about)



Read the percentages in each panel: the share of aircraft already lower than a quiet continuous descent as they pass over Brockenhurst — rising 83% → 87% → 87% for all arrivals and 66% → 73% → 74% for airliners. Flying low and level (instead of gliding down) needs engine power, which is the noise residents hear. Source: aircraft's own broadcast (ADS-B) position data via the OPDI / OpenSky open dataset. Prepared from public data — not affiliated with the airport.